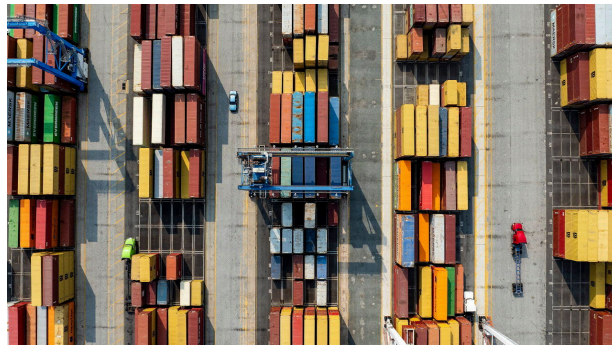


World in Brief: Trump's new global tariffs; oil prices surge



Photograph: Getty Images

America imposed **tariffs** of between 10% and 12.5% on goods from 60 countries, including Britain, Japan and Mexico. The Trump administration accused them of failing to police imports of goods made with forced labour. They took effect on Friday, when a separate 10% global levy expired. Donald Trump has [repeatedly adjusted his tariffs](#) since the Supreme Court struck down their main legal justification in February.

Brent crude, the international oil benchmark, rose above \$100 a barrel for the first time since May. Mr Trump told Axios, a news site, that he was mulling a “massive attack” on **Iran**. Meanwhile [the Houthis](#), an Iran-backed Yemeni militia, struck two Saudi Arabian oil tankers in the Red Sea; Mr Trump said he would hold Iran responsible for further attacks.

Ted Lieu, a Democratic congressman, and Nathaniel Moran, a Republican, proposed a bill that would give America's government the authority to **shut down AI models** run by private firms. The introduction of the AI Kill Switch Act follows an incident this week, in which [OpenAI's models went rogue](#) and hacked Hugging Face, an open-source platform. Michael Kratsios, Mr Trump's top technology adviser, said he was closely monitoring the situation.

After American markets closed, **Intel** reported unexpectedly strong second-quarter revenues of \$16.1bn, up 25% year on year, potentially offering jittery investors some relief. The [American chipmaker](#) was boosted by demand for data centres and AI: sales leapt by 59%, to \$6.3bn. Intel said it expected revenues between \$15.8bn and \$16.8bn in the third quarter.

“No10 North”, a new government base in Manchester created by [Andy Burnham](#), opens on Friday. Mr Burnham, who became Britain’s new prime minister this week, says the office will speed up “devolution” and counter what he sees as an overconcentration of decision-making power in London. He will chair the first meeting there of a revived National Economic Council, a cabinet body aimed at boosting growth.

Mr Trump said **America’s** civilian **nuclear** deal with **Saudi Arabia** is “totally subject” to Saudi Arabia recognising the state of Israel by joining the Abraham accords. Mr Trump also said [the agreement](#), which Congress must still review, does not include “enrichment of material”. Saudi Arabia has [refused to normalise ties with Israel](#) without a serious path to creating a Palestinian state.

Speaking to *The Economist* in his first extended [interview](#) since SpaceX’s blockbuster IPO, **Elon Musk** made [three bold predictions](#): AI will surpass human intelligence within five years; robots in the workplace will render money meaningless within ten; and Britain will descend into civil war within 20. The world’s richest man insisted that AI will control almost everything eventually.

Figure of the day: \$1trn, the amount wiped off SpaceX’s market value since its post-IPO peak of \$2.6trn. [Read](#) our interview with Elon Musk, the rocketry firm’s owner and world’s richest man.

The Middle Eastern oil shock, Houthi edition



Photograph: Getty Images

After America and Iran agreed to reopen the Strait of Hormuz in June, the price of Brent crude fell to nearly \$70 a barrel. Now, after 13 nights of American strikes on Iran, the global oil-price benchmark is again in triple digits.

It could stay there for a while. [Traffic through Hormuz](#) has petered out since Iran resumed attacking tankers and America reimposed its embargo on the country's ports. This week Yemeni Houthi rebels declared a blockade of Saudi Arabian ports in the Red Sea; the kingdom had rerouted its oil exports to Asia, about two-thirds of the total, through that waterway. So far the Houthis say they have attacked two ships; more have turned back.

Meanwhile, Ukrainian drone strikes on Russia's energy infrastructure continue to disrupt its fuel exports, too. The crunch is worst in refined products: prices of petrol, diesel and jet fuel have all reached their highest level in months. The [biggest oil-supply shock](#) in history just got bigger.

India's young cockroaches

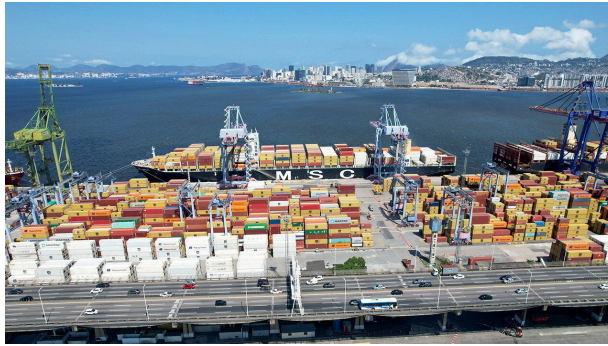


Photograph: Shutterstock

Three months ago the Cockroach Janta Party did not exist. This week the Gen-Z movement was behind Delhi's biggest protest in more than half a decade. The CJP began as a joke in response to a comment by India's Supreme Court chief justice comparing unemployed young people to cockroaches. Over the past week the group's supporters have taken to the streets across the country in largely peaceful protests.

Young people are outraged over a recent leak of entrance exam papers. But underneath is a deeper anger: the world's largest youth population endures gruelling challenges to enter too few good universities, only to graduate into a poor job market. Narendra Modi's government seems to have been taken by surprise at the strength of feeling. The protesters have rallied around a [hunger striker](#), Sonam Wangchuk, whom authorities dragged off to hospital. On Friday he announced he was calling off his fast following assurances that the protesters would not be punished. But that has done little to stop them. They have vowed to remain on the streets until their main demand—that the education minister resigns—is met. India's cockroaches will not be easily crushed.

Donald Trump's beastly tariffs



Photograph: Getty Images

After it was decapitated by America's Supreme Court, Donald Trump's [hydra-like tariff regime](#) is sprouting new heads. On Monday the President invoked an obscure law to impose 50% duties on some Canadian goods, claiming it was in retaliation to discrimination against American cars, alcohol and dairy. The levies, which cover nearly \$20bn of imports, will not take effect until August 19th, seemingly to provide leverage in stalled trade talks.

On Friday a separate 10% global tariff on most imports reached its 150-day limit and expired. Replacements have come into place. The administration announced duties of between 10% and 12.5% on 60 economies failing to police imports of goods made with forced labour. More are expected later this year on big trading partners blamed for slowing America's manufacturing revival by overproducing goods. Together the measures would recreate Mr Trump's old tariff schedule, and many trade lawyers expect them to last. It will take more to slay the beast.

An ICC prosecutor in the dock



Photograph: Reuters

“No foot soldier, no commander, no civilian leader—no one—can act with impunity,” declared Karim Khan, the chief prosecutor of the International Criminal Court in 2024 as he [issued arrest warrants](#) for Israelis and Palestinians whom he accused of committing war crimes in Gaza and Israel. On Friday Mr Khan’s own actions will be on trial, when countries belonging to the ICC vote on whether to fire him because of allegations that he sexually abused two junior members of his staff. (Mr Khan denies wrongdoing and says he had no sexual relationship with either woman.)

Many hope the vote will draw a line under a scandal that has hurt the credibility of the ICC, which is embattled for other reasons. America, which does not belong to the court, has imposed sanctions on ICC officials who are investigating American and Israeli citizens. Many observers may see a vote to remove Mr Khan as capitulation to governments that want to punish him for bringing charges against Israeli leaders.

Daily quiz



Illustration: Sandra Navarro

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to [\[email protected\]](#). We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Friday: The ILCA 7, ILCA 6 and Mixed 470 are Olympic categories for racing which kind of boat?

Thursday: What is the common British term for a bed surrounded by bars and designed for a baby or small child?

The art of victory is learned in defeat.

Simón Bolívar